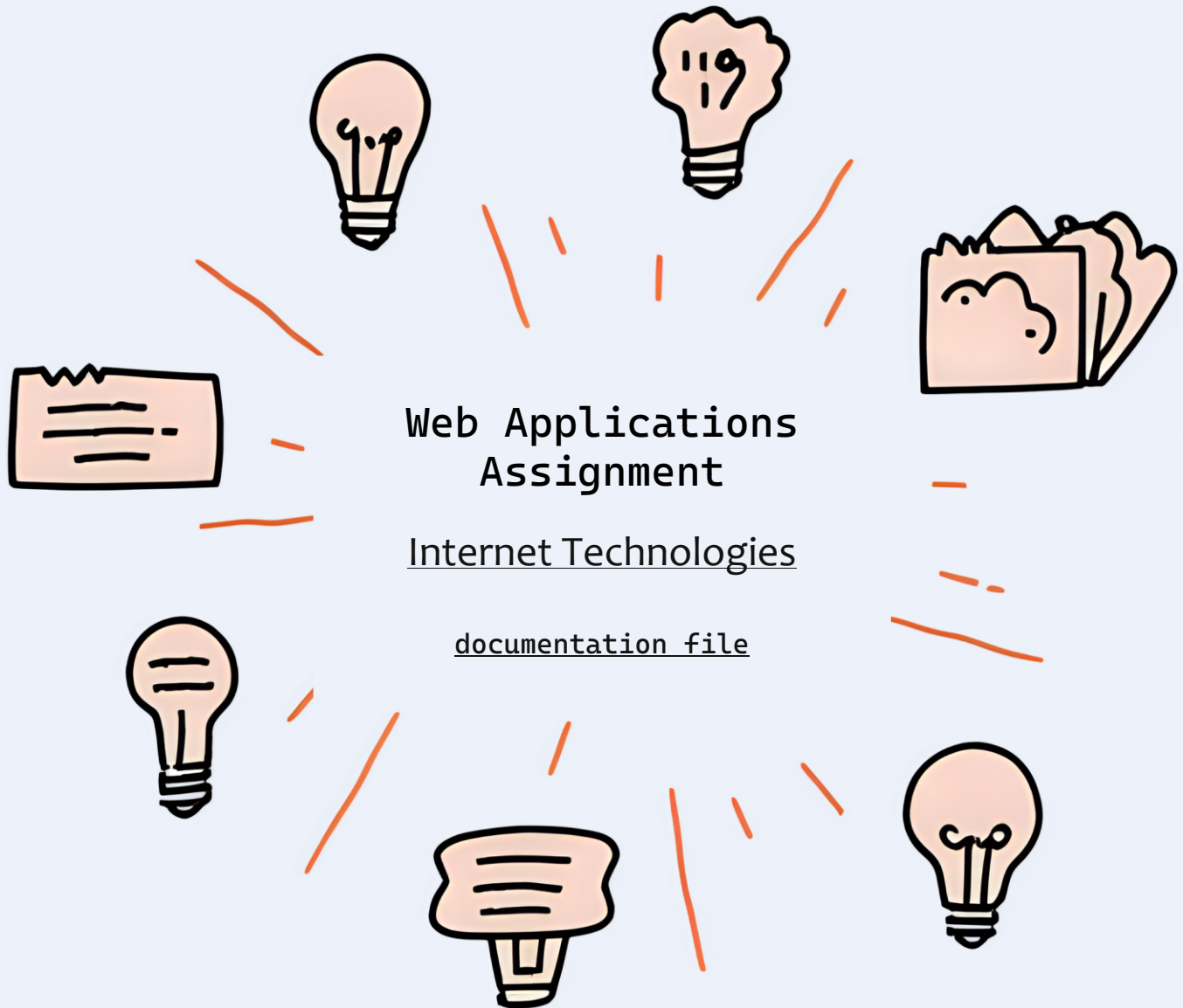


Assignment 2



Prepared by : SARA MOHAMMED JUMAA

STUDENT ID : 2420312

DATE: 22-12-2025

➤ Project overview

This website represents a **personal portfolio** that highlights my skills, creative identity, and work in areas such as content creation, visual identity development, graphic design, and web design.

The main goal for this website to showcase my skills and work in a modern and effective way, building a credible and trustworthy personal brand while encouraging professional contact and collaboration

The website targets potential employers, freelance clients, and academic evaluators within the digital media and creative industries. It also aims to attract organizations and brands seeking creative and professional services in graphic design, web design, and content creation.

➤ How the Website Works

The website functions as a **single-page application (SPA) portfolio**, that allows users to navigate easily between different sections. It is divided into four main functional components for clarity and usability.

- Navigation (Header)

The website's navigation is integrated into a **sticky-ready header**. It is designed to provide users with a clear and consistent interface for accessing different sections. The header contains a structured navigation menu and anchor links that allow users to move seamlessly *between About Me, My Works, and Contact Me*. Together, these components function as the primary control center, enhancing usability and providing intuitive access to the portfolio's main

- The Hero Section (Header)

The first element that users can see. It contains the "**core identity**" (*name and title*) alongside **Call-to-Action (CTA)** buttons like "About Me" and "My Works" designed to encourage immediate engagement, allowing visitors to dive directly into my professional background or my creative portfolio with a single click.

- Content Core: The Body Section

The **About Me** section utilizes a balanced split-screen layout that combines a professional image with a textual description of my skills, experience, and brand mission. The layout is designed to provide visual balance, ensuring that the image and text have equal prominence, while giving visitors a concise overview of the professional background and creative approach

The second section, '**Recent Works**,' features a gallery-style display of visual identity and design projects, organized in a clean, repetitive grid. It emphasizes the consistency and professional quality of my work, ensuring each project is highlighted individually. It provides an effective browsing experience that highlights individual projects without losing the overall visual balance of the brand.

The Conversion Zone (Contact & Footer)

The bottom section is dedicated to accessibility and user engagement, serving as the final touchpoint of the user journey. It prioritizes accessibility by placing direct communication links—email and phone—within a clean, high-contrast layout. The minimalist design ensures that contact details are highly visible, minimizing friction for potential clients or partners seeking to establish a connection.



➤ Styling Approach

layout method: Flexbox Architecture

The website primarily uses the CSS **Flexbox model** to organize its content. Flexbox enables flexible alignment, spacing, and distribution of elements across the page—such as in the Hero and About Me sections—ensuring that visual elements and text descriptions have equal visual weight and a balanced, professional appearance.



Technical Implementation

- **justify-content: space-between;** applied to the **.hero** and **.Me** classes, this creates that "equal visual weight" by pushing the text and the image to opposite sides, utilizing the full width of the container.
- **align-items: center;** This ensures that text is vertically centered relative to the images, maintaining a balanced layout regardless of text length and preventing a top-heavy appearance.

responsiveness strategy: Adaptive Design

The website follows a **liquid layout approach** to ensure optimal display across a wide range of devices, including desktops, tablets, and smartphones. Through the strategic use of **media queries** the layout, font sizes, image dimensions automatically adjust its structure based on screen size.

Technical Implementation

- **Media Queries:** Strategic breakpoints are set at **768px** and **480px** to detect screen size variations and dynamically adjust CSS rules. These breakpoints allow the layout to respond effectively to tablet and mobile devices.
- **Flex-Direction Switching:** In the **Hero**, **About Me**, and **Contact** sections, the layout shifts from a horizontal row (**flex-direction: row**) on desktop screens to a vertical stack (**flex-direction: column**) on smaller devices. This prevents content crowding and supports a natural, scroll-friendly reading flow.

design choices

- **Interactive Elements:** Interactive elements such as **hover effects** on portfolio images and **call-to-action buttons** enhance user engagement and provide immediate visual feedback.
- **Minimalism:** Clean layouts and generous white space are used to maintain a visually appealing interface and direct user attention toward the primary content
- **Color Palette:** Soft colors are used to create a calm and professional look, with contrast applied to ensure readability. By limiting the color usage to a specific palette of **mocha, lavender, and soft pink** tones, the **60–30–10 color rule** is applied throughout the design:
 - **60% Primary (Mocha):** Creates the atmosphere.
 - **30% Secondary (Lavender/Pink):** Provides the structure.
 - **10% Accent (Hover colors/CTA):** Highlights the "Key Elements."

This limited palette is exactly what creates the visual harmony has been mentioned; it prevents the website from looking cluttered and ensures that user attention remains focused on the showcased work

- **Typography:** A combination of modern and decorative typefaces is used to reflect creativity while maintaining clarity

In this project, this choice is executed through two specific font families, each serving a different psychological and functional purpose:

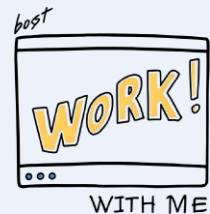
- **Poppins (Sans-serif):** Used for body text and navigation to provide **modern readability**. Its clean, geometric structure conveys stability and professionalism, ensuring the to easily process information related to skills and experience without effort.
- **Brush Script MT (Script):** Used for **expressive headings** like "**creative**" and "**about me.**" This adds a personal, "hand-written" touch that represents your unique creative identity and softens the rigidity of the grid-based layout.

➤ JavaScript Functionality

Dynamic Content Rendering :

Instead of hardcoding projects in HTML This projects section is dynamically generated using JavaScript

- Project data is stored in an array of objects (`projects`), where each object contains *details such as title, category, image, and interaction type*.
- The (`render Projects`) function loops through the array and injects the project elements into the DOM dynamically.
- This approach improves scalability and maintainability, allowing new projects to be added projects just by updating the array, without touching the **HTML** structure.



Filtering & Search Functionality

This website implemented a dual-purpose filtering system.

- **Search:** The (`onkeyup`) event on your search bar triggers (`filterProjects`).
- **Category:** The "All", "Branding", and "Design" buttons also trigger the same function.
- By providing these functions users can filter projects by category or search by keyword

Modal Windows (Project Details)

A two Modal windows are implented in this website to display detailed project galleries

Inside of these modal galleries, images can be viewed individually in a full-screen lightbox. This feature enhances visual clarity and user engagement with design content.

- **Gallery Modal:** (`openModal`) and (`closeModal`) handle the large project overlays (`designsModal` and `adsModal`).
- **Image Lightbox:** (`viewSingle`) creates a "modal within a modal" effect to see a high-res version of a specific image.

Navigation Enhancement

Clicking on navigation links scrolls smoothly to the target section instead of jumping instantly, providing a polished and professional navigation experience across the single-page portfolio

- This script "**listens**" for clicks on your navigation links. Instead of the browser jumping instantly to a section (which can be jarring), it uses `target.scroll Into View` (`{ behavior: 'smooth' }`).

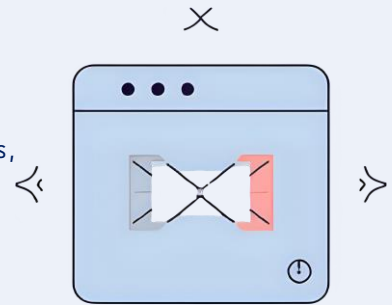
Theme Toggle (Dark / Light Mode)

The website includes a theme toggle feature that allows users to switch between dark and light modes, enhancing visual comfort Provides accessibility for users who prefer high-contrast light text or reduced-glare dark backgrounds.

- (`toggleTheme`): This function switches the visual mode by conditionally updating `the body` element's background and text colors.

➤ Hosting & Deployment

My portfolio website is a client-side and a single-page website built using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript. Since it does not require a backend server or database, it can be hosted using static or cloud-based hosting services., it can be efficiently hosted using modern static hosting or cloud hosting solutions.



→ **Static Hosting Platform :** Hosted via **GitHub Pages**.

a platforms that is ideal for front-end projects, as they host static files and automatically deploy updates when code changes are pushed to a repository. They also provide a built-in HTTPS, and support high availability.

- **Live URL:** <https://saramh098.github.io/my-first-website/>
- **Deployment Workflow:** I utilized a Git-based workflow where Any updates pushed to the GitHub repository are automatically built and published to the live website through GitHub Pages .This approach follows the principles of Continuous Deployment (CD), ensuring that the live version always reflects the latest code changes
- **Security:** Served over **HTTPS**, ensuring a secure connection for all visitors.

→ **Cloud Providers (AWS / Google Cloud / Azure)**

Cloud providers offer advanced hosting services that allow the website to scale, integrate cloud storage, and use additional tools such as analytics and monitoring.

- So In addition to GitHub Pages, this portfolio website is also deployed using **Amazon Web Services (AWS) S3 Static Website Hosting**. This demonstrates the use of cloud infrastructure to host front-end applications with high availability and the ability to expand functionality in the future.
- **Live URL:** <http://sara-first-website.s3-website-us-east-1.amazonaws.com>

➤ Cloud Services Could Improve the Website Performance & Security

service	Benefit for the website
Content Delivery Network (CDN)	Distributes static files (HTML, CSS, JS, images) across servers worldwide.so that any user in any region doesn't have to wait for a server for long time to respond.
Domain & DNS Management	By moving from a .github.io URL to a custom domain (e.g., sara-portfolio.com) using AWS Route 53 services, the website benefits from high availability and fast DNS resolution.
HTTPS Certificates	Using AWS Certificate Manager ensures secure communication between users and the website by enabling HTTPS encryption. This protects user data from interception, increases user trust, and positively impacts search engine optimization (SEO) rankings.
Analytics & Monitoring	Analytics and monitoring tools track user activity and website performance. They help identify popular sections, detect issues, and notify administrators if the site goes offline.

➤ References

- **OpenAI.** (2024). *ChatGPT* (large language model). <https://www.openai.com>
- **Google.** (2024). *Gemini* (AI language model). <https://deepmind.google/technologies/gemini/>
- I used AI tools to assist in structuring **my JavaScript logic**. The AI supported the transition from hard-coded HTML to a data-driven approach using an **array of objects**. This design choice improves scalability, as adding a new project now requires inserting a single data entry rather than rewriting or duplicating complex HTML structures.
- When deploying to **AWS S3**, I encountered "**Access Denied**" errors with my JSON Bucket Policy. I used the AI to interpret AWS error messages, validate bucket policy syntax, and explain cloud security settings such as public access control and HTTPS requirements for static website hosting.
- In addition I used AI tools to polish the technical documentation, ensuring clarity, a professional tone, and correct terminology. This included refining explanations related to CSS layout methods, JavaScript functionality, and hosting architecture